

phone got considerably hot when running benchmarks, shooting 4K video, and playing intensive games. For example, 10 minutes of COD: Mobile spiked the CPU temperature to around 44 degrees Celsius. I played Call of Duty: Mobile at Very High graphics and Max frame rate, and while I did not face any major lag or stutters, the gaming experience just felt slightly janky compared to other flagships. There was a definitely lack of fluidity when gaming.

In regular day-to-day tasks, the phone operates very smoothly. Multitasking is a breeze as well, with the phone being able to keep 20+ apps open at the same time. The only problem is that the OnePlus Open – despite having flagship specifications – does feel like a tier below 2023 flagships when it comes to raw performance.

UI

The phone runs on OxygenOS 13.2 based on Android 13. OnePlus has promised four years of security updates and five years of security updates.

The foldable interface on the OnePlus Open is extremely intuitive, functional, and fun. There's so much you can do on this that actually makes sense from a multitasking perspective. Let me explain.

On most foldable devices, you can split your screen into 2, 3 or 4, and then these apps take up restricted space on the screen; often contorting to weird aspect ratios. OnePlus employs something they call 'Open Canvas' that reimages multitasking and screen-splitting in a really innovative manner. With Open Canvas, split windows aren't restricted to the physical size of the display and they can spill over the outside, leaving only a sliver of the window that users can tap to access at any time.

What this means is that even if you have split the window into 2 or 3, you can expand each window to fill almost the entirety of the screen allowing you to work on the apps with much larger space than possible on other foldables. If you need to access any app from the group, simply tap the edge of the other app that will be displayed on the sides, and it expands to full. If you don't like this and prefer to see your windows side by side, you can do that

as well. They can be stretched and resized as you see fit, allowing users to really take control of their multitasking.

In addition to this, up to nine multi-app presets can be saved on the phone and opened up in a jiffy. The action for window splitting is also super convenient; you just swipe down with two fingers from the top of an app to open another window and select the app you want in split screen view. Photos, links and files can be easily dragged and dropped between these windows for quick sharing.

There's also a desktop-like taskbar at the bottom that shows recently-opened apps and files which you can quickly open or share. Folding the phone at 90 degrees also opens up dual screen preview in some apps such as YouTube with the media playing on top and controls at the bottom. There are a ton of gestures for multitasking that you can learn by visiting your Settings window, and while there is a steep learning curve, once you get through it, multitasking becomes child's play. Overall, this is a super smooth foldable interface – what could make it better is stylus support which would just take productivity to the next level.

BATTERY LIFE

The OnePlus Open has one of the largest batteries in the foldable segment. The phone houses a 4,805 mAh battery with support for 67W SUPERVOOC charging. There's an 80 W SUPERVOOC charger inside the retail box. The battery life of the OnePlus Open is pretty decent. While it isn't the best I've experienced on a foldable, it won't have you on a constant hunt for a charger.

The phone provides about 5-6 hours of screen-on time with moderate to heavy usage, which is pretty decent. In our 4K video loop test, the phone lasted for a good 14 hours and 42 minutes from full battery to empty. Half an hour of watching Netflix dropped the battery percentage by 4 per cent, and 15 minutes of Call of Duty: Mobile dropped it by 5 per cent. Most users should reach the end of the day with about 10-15 per cent battery remaining.

The 67 W charger does an excellent job of topping up this battery quickly. It took

about 46 minutes to charge the phone from 0-100 per cent, which is the fastest I've tested in the foldable segment! Sadly though, there's no wireless charging, which is quite disappointing on a phone costing way more than a lakh.

VERDICT

So, the question is – has OnePlus finally perfected the foldable phone formula? The answer? They've come extremely close. The OnePlus Open is an exemplary foldable – one that shows off how to do multitasking and cameras right. In my opinion, the foldable interface on the OnePlus Open is the absolute best in the market right now. It capitalises on the large real estate the inner screen offers in a manner that no one has yet. Additionally, the cameras are capable enough to be compared against regular candy-bar flagship phones.

Although I really enjoy using this phone, it is not perfect. The refresh rate issues can take a serious toll on battery life, battery life is not the best in the segment, and gaming is not as seamless as on flagships. However, for OnePlus' first attempt at a foldable, this is an incredibly refined product. One that I imagine will only get better with future software updates. To know if it does, tune in to digit.in for a long-term review a few months down the road!

–Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: Snapdragon 8 Gen 2 | GPU: Adreno 740 | RAM: 16 GB LPDDR5X | Storage: 512 GB UFS 4.0 | OS: OxygenOS 13.2 based on Android 13 | Colours: Emerald Dusk, Voyager Black | Thickness (unfolded): 5.8 mm (Emerald Dusk), 5.9 mm (Voyager Black) | Weight: 239 g (Voyager Black), 245 g (Emerald Dusk) | Primary display: 7.82" AMOLED with LTPO 3.0, 2440 x 2268 pixels, 1-120 Hz refresh rate | Cover display: 6.31" AMOLED with LTPO 3.0, 2484 x 1116 pixels, 10-120 Hz refresh rate | Cameras (rear): 48 MP Sony LYT-T808 'Pixel Stacked' camera + 64 MP OmniVision OV64B 3x optical zoom telephoto camera + 48 MP Sony IMX581 ultra-wide camera | Cameras (front): 20 MP (inside) + 32 MP (outside) | Battery capacity and charging: 4,805 mAh, 67 W SUPERVOOC charging

CONTACT

Company: OnePlus | Phone: N/A | Email: onepluscare@oneplus.com | Website: <https://www.oneplus.in/>